What Comes In, What Goes Out

A monthly income and care cost worksheet for Mom. Write down the numbers you can see, and where each one came from.

“About what she gets from Social Security” is a guess. The amount on last month's deposit is a number you can write down, and a number with a paper behind it is one a professional can use.

Work from what's in front of you: a bank statement, a benefit letter, the latest bill. Copy each amount as it appears and note where you found it. If you can't find something, write “not found yet” and leave it.

Social Security and pensions

What arrives each month, the amount as it shows on the deposit or the letter, and the paper you copied it from.

FOR EXAMPLE Social Security: amount copied from the March bank statement, deposited on the third. Pension from the school district: shows as a deposit on the same statement. Haven't found a letter for it.

Retirement accounts, annuities and other income

Regular withdrawals from a retirement account, annuity payments, interest, anything else that comes in. Note how often each one arrives.

FOR EXAMPLE Annuity: a payment each month from an insurance company. The name is on the bank statement; no contract found yet. Ask Karen.

What care is costing each month

From the latest bill or rate sheet: the monthly charge, and anything billed on top of it. Copy the lines as they are written.

FOR EXAMPLE Facility bill dated the 1st: room and care on one line, pharmacy and supplies on separate lines. Don't know yet which of those come every month.

Her other regular monthly expenses

What still gets paid while she is getting care: housing, utilities, insurance premiums, phone, prescriptions, loan payments. Mark the ones that come out of her account automatically.

FOR EXAMPLE Electric and phone: paid automatically from checking. Health insurance premium: comes out every three months, amount on the January statement. House insurance: don't know who pays it.

What's an estimate, and what we couldn't find

Anything above that you wrote from memory, and anything still blank. Don't guess to fill a line.

FOR EXAMPLE Pension amount is from memory. No bill yet from the home care agency for her first two weeks.

Who filled this in, on what date, and from which papers

What this shows you

Three things: what comes in each month, what goes out, and which of those numbers came from paper and which are still estimates. It stops there on purpose. It doesn't subtract one from the other, work out how long Mom's money may last, or say anything about what she may qualify for, and nothing here adds up to a score or a result. Rules vary by state, and nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice; those questions go to your Medicaid planner or the appropriate licensed professional.

Ready for the next step?

You've written down what comes in and what goes out, with a source beside each number. The planning interview picks up from there: it asks about the rest of your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for Mom's care.

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